Prompting with Microsoft Copilot

WORKING WITH MICROSOFT COPILOT



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About me

Member of Microsoft Copilot and Agentic AI team

- 15+ years in IT and AI
- Helping teams transform work with Copilot
- Designing secure, practical AI solutions

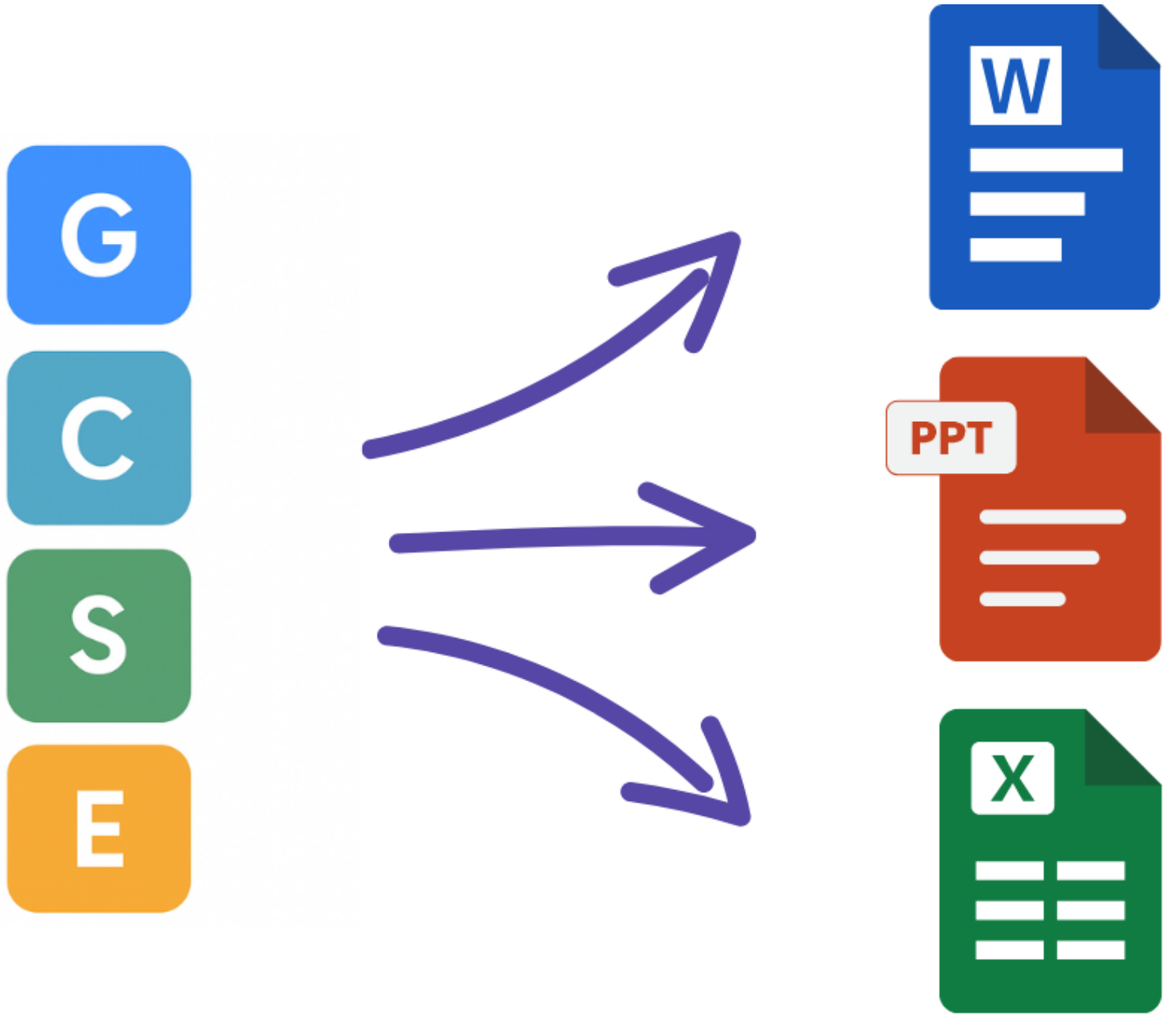


Overview

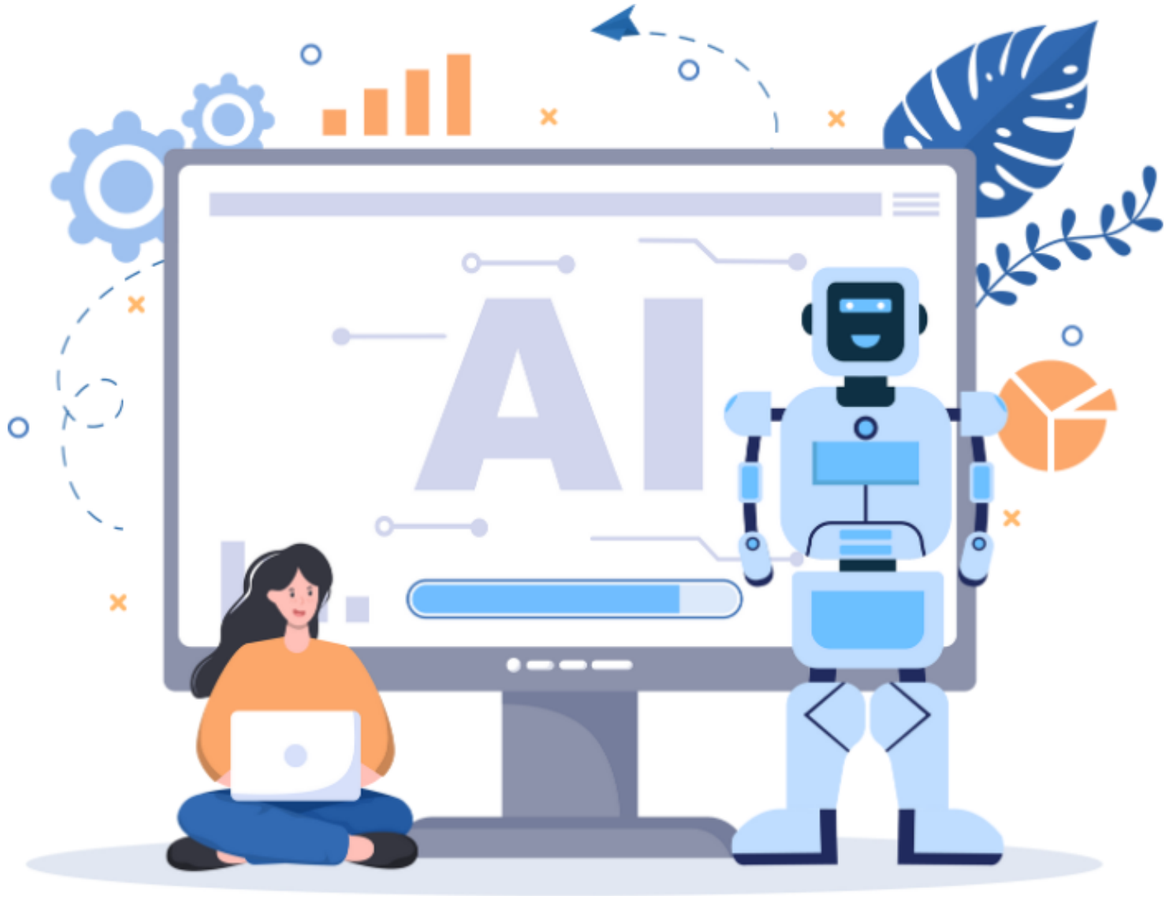
Copilot

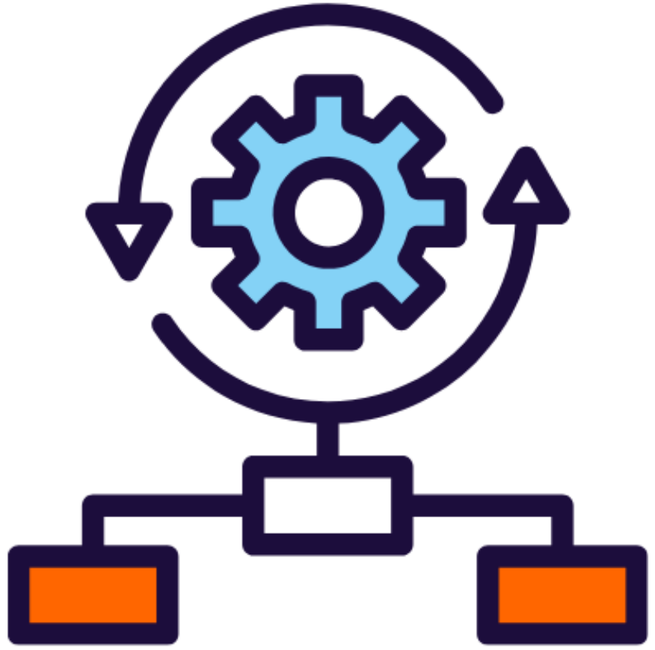


Overview



Overview









Why prompt engineering matters

❌ Vague prompt

Can you put together a presentation?

Copilot

Thanks for your request to put together a presentation. I searched across your enterprise data—including files, emails, chats, transcripts, and meetings—but **no relevant materials** were found that mention or relate to a presentation.

To help me create something tailored and useful, could you let me know:

- **What is the topic** of the presentation?
- **Who is the audience** (e.g. classmates, instructors, colleagues)?
- **How long should it be** (e.g. number of slides or minutes)?
- **Any specific content or format** you want included (e.g. charts, bullet points, images)?

Once I have that, I can start building it for you right away.

✅ Clear, specific prompt

Create a 5-slide presentation that explains why prompt engineering matters.
- Each slide should have a clear title and 2–3 bullet points.
- Keep the language simple and engaging for beginners.
- End with a summary slide highlighting key takeaways.

Copilot

Here's a 5-slide presentation introducing **why prompt engineering matters**, designed for beginners with simple, engaging language:

Slide 1: What Is Prompt Engineering?

- It's the art of crafting effective instructions for AI tools.
- Helps you get accurate, useful responses from AI.
- Think of it like asking the right question to get the best answer.

Slide 2: Why It Matters in Business

- Saves time by automating tasks and insights.
- Improves decision-making with clearer AI outputs.
- Boosts productivity across teams and departments.

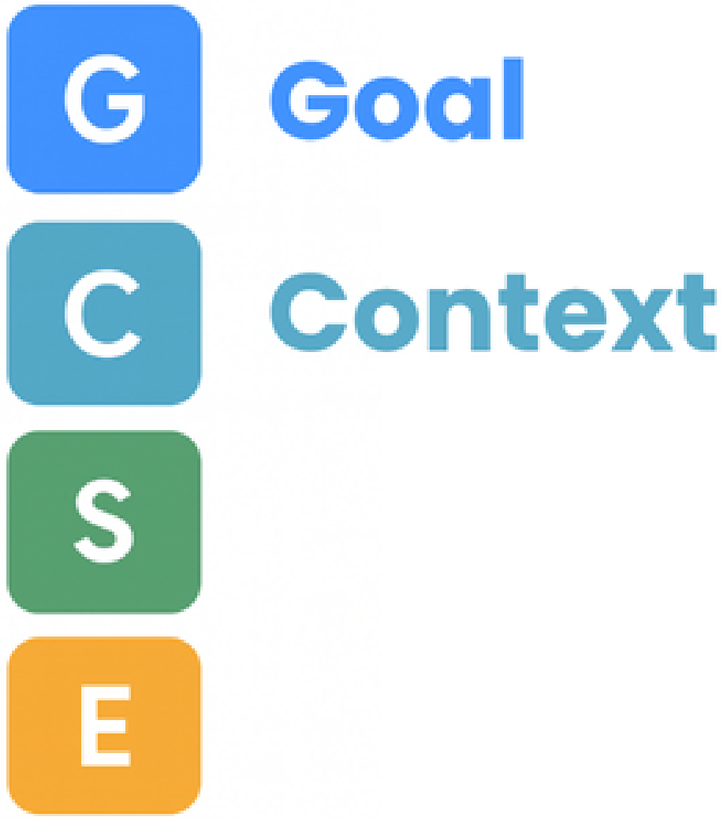
The GCSE Framework



The GCSE Framework



The GCSE Framework



The GCSE Framework



The GCSE Framework



- GCSE - a checklist for clear prompts
- Avoids vague or inconsistent answers
- Works across Microsoft 365 apps (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)

💡 **Note:**

Not every prompt needs all four elements. Use the GCSE framework as a toolkit and pick the parts that fit your task.



G Goal

- Be clear and specific
- Focus on the action and the task
  - Keeps Copilot focused on the right outcome



C Context

- Give background so Copilot understands your task.
- Clear context improves accuracy.
  - Helps Copilot tailor responses to your situation



S Source

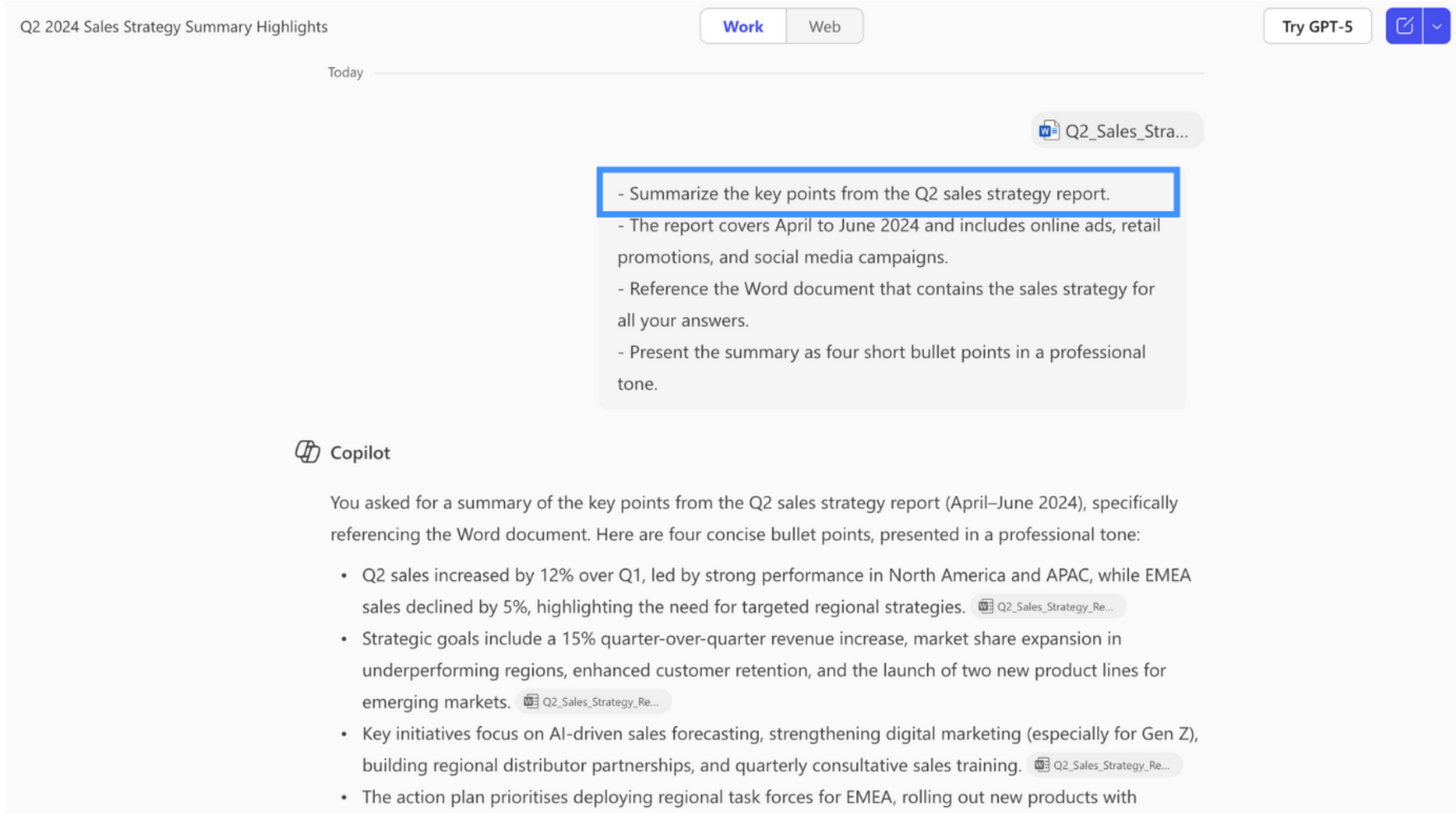
- Tell Copilot where to find info.
- Avoid gaps or guesswork.
  - Grounds Copilot's answers in real data and reduces errors



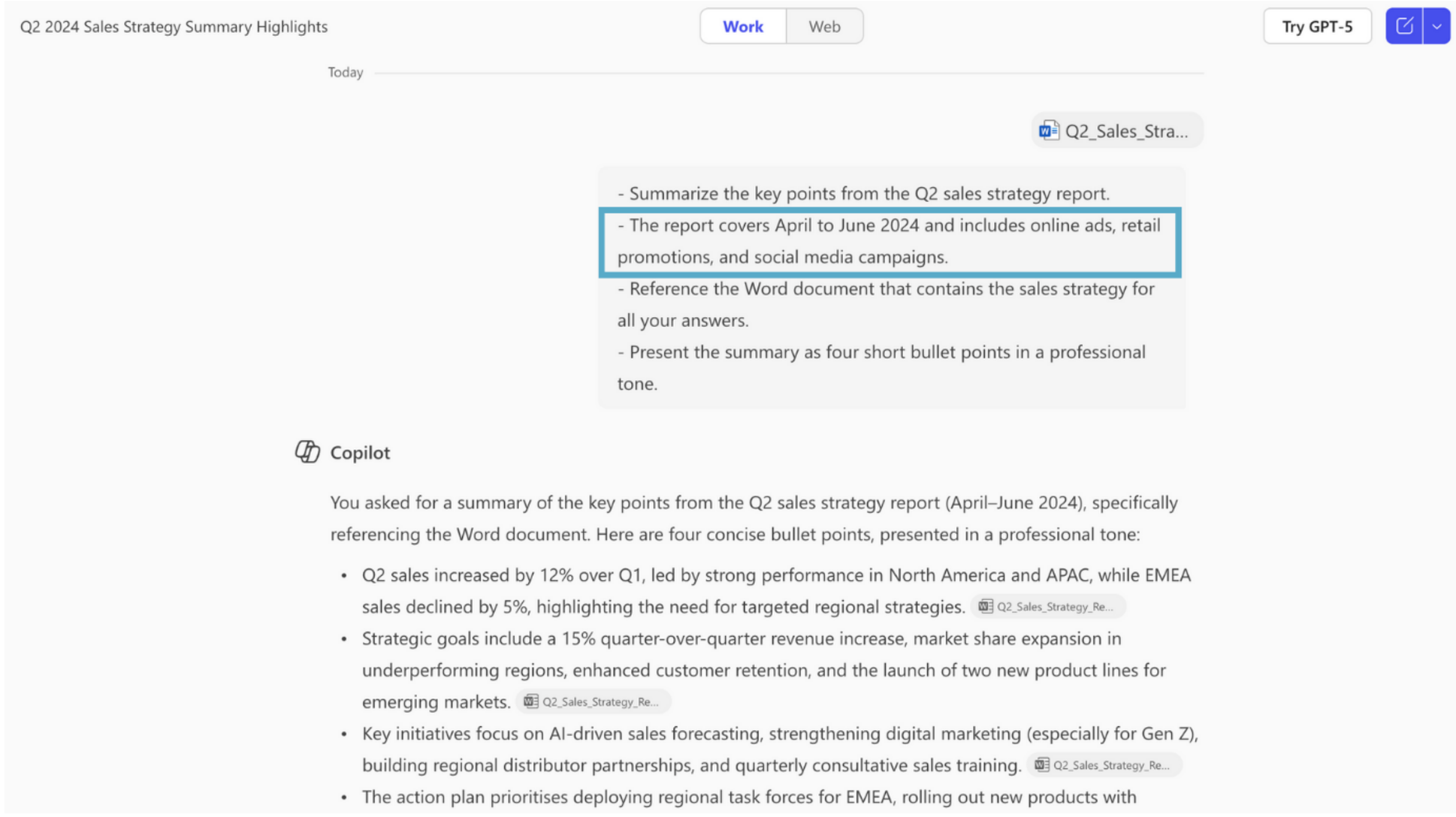
E Expectation

- Explain how you want the response.
- Set clear expectations for usable output.
  - Ensures the response meets your needs and saves time refining results.

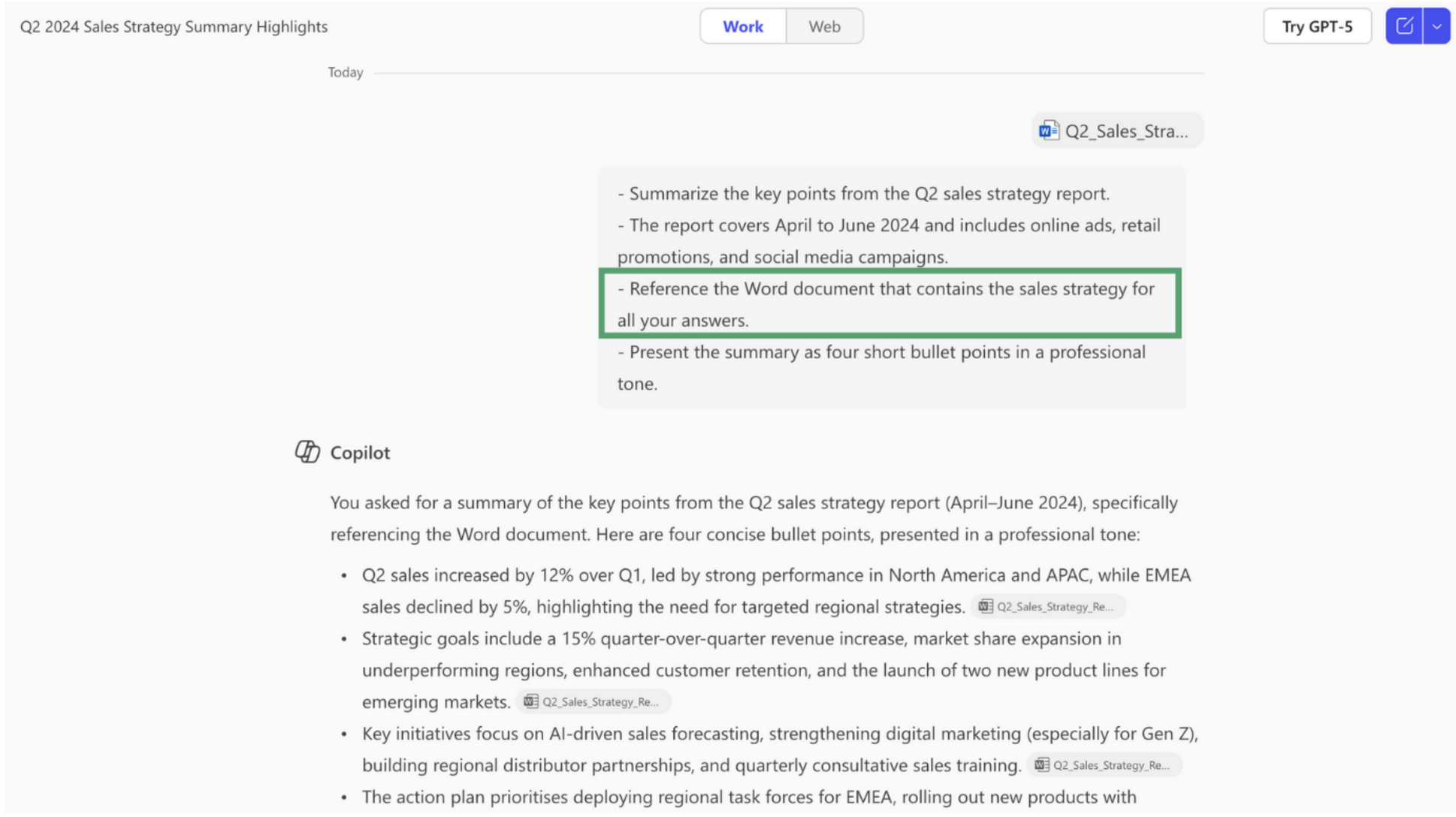
Putting it all together



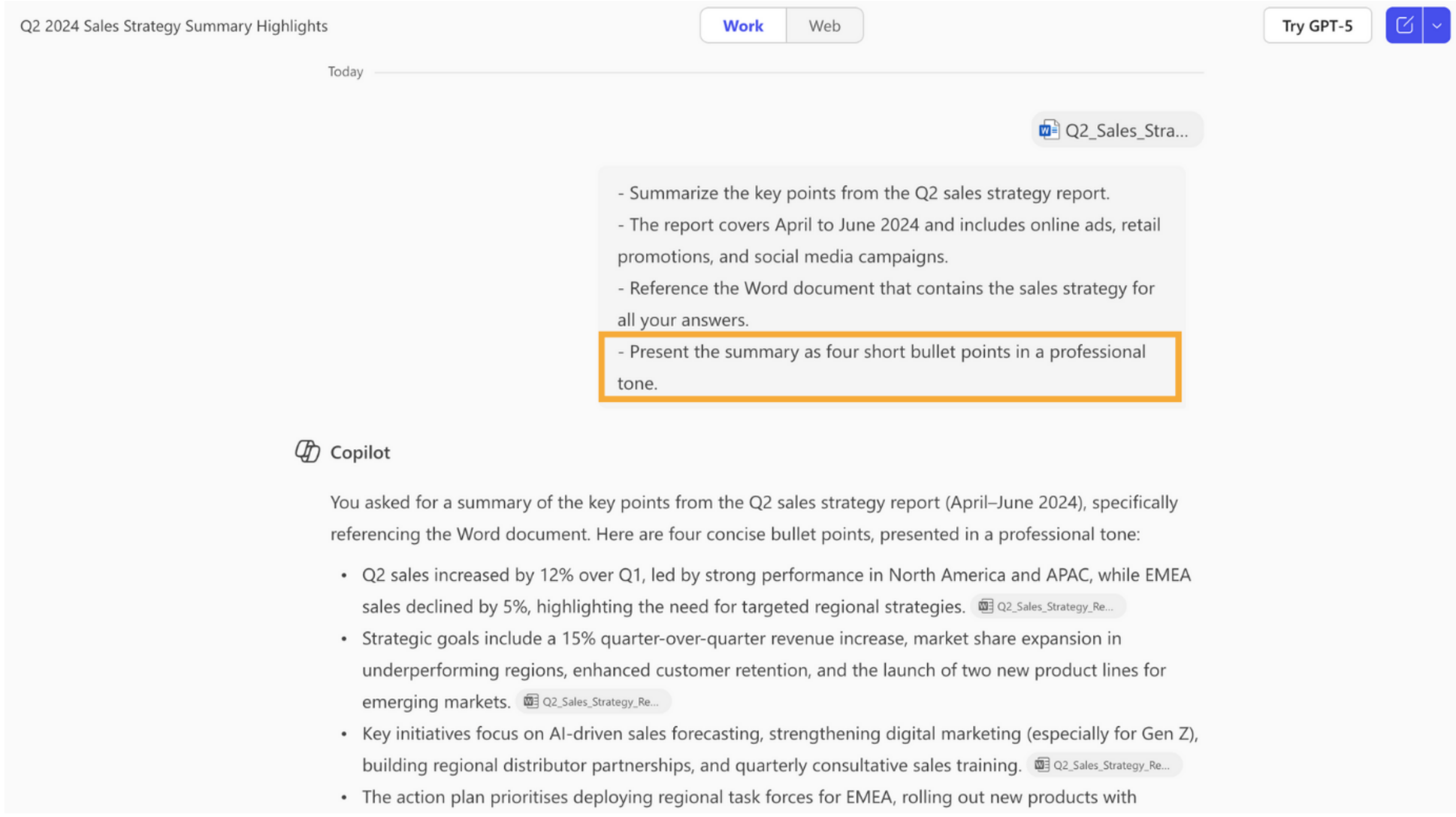
Putting it all together



Putting it all together



Putting it all together



Let's practice!

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Multi-step prompts and refinement

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Why go beyond the basics?

- Some tasks involve multiple steps or tools
- Examples:
  - Updating a client report with research, a draft, and a summary
  - Preparing a team briefing in Excel with filters, trends, and charts
- Break complex tasks into smaller, clear steps



DEMO VIDEO

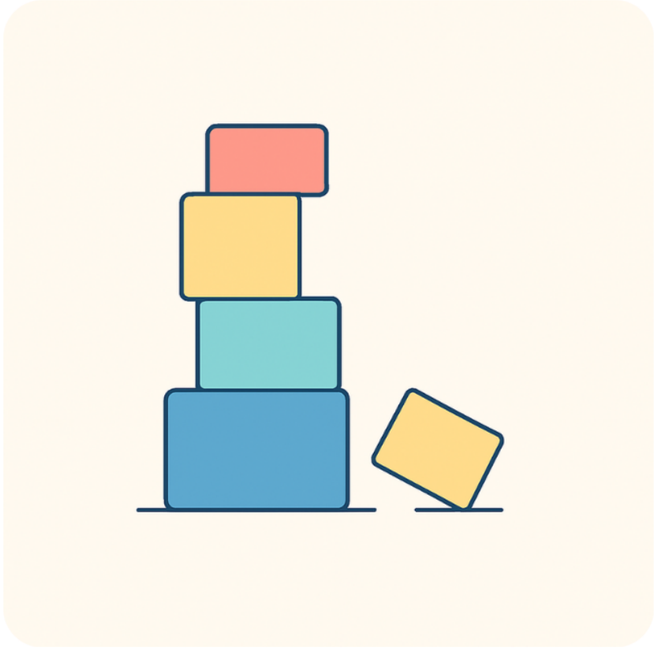
DEMO VIDEO

DEMO VIDEO

DEMO VIDEO

Multi-step vs. refinement

- Break the task into steps to help guide Copilot
- Stack the steps like blocks for a precise, complete analysis



- Polish the draft: shorten, adjust tone, add details.
- Add finishing touches to make it clear and professional.



Let's practice!

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